

Pamphlet 8

Year 1, Pamphlet 8

15 May 2026

primordia

about latin and its culture

For previous versions, refer to our website at <https://latin2u.github.io>.

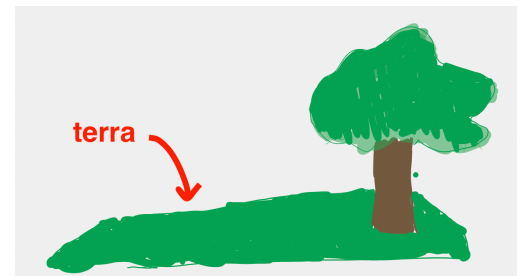
Introduction

For this version, I've changed the layout drastically. There is now only one column, even though it reads more as a handout, but now I can add graphics without the page being disrupted. However, the content doesn't change at all, and this time, I will cover common abbreviations (like RIP, where "rest in peace" is just a convenient term), relative clauses, and indirect statements this time!

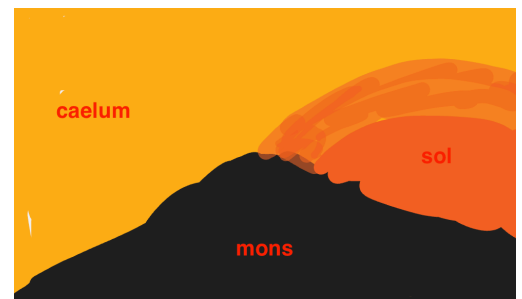
Word List 4: Nature (nouns)

Nouns:

Latin	English	Information and derivatives
terra, terrae	earth/land/ground	1st f. (feminine) Terrace, terrestrial, territory, terrain
mons, montis	mountain	3rd m. (masculine) Mount, mountain, ultramontane, montane
vallis, vallis	valley	3rd f. valley
silva, silvae	forest	1st f. sylvian
hortus, horti	garden	2nd m. horticulture
ager, agri	field	2nd m. agriculture
lapis, lapidus	stone	3rd m.
mare, maris	A body of water	3rd n. (neuter) marine
flumen, fluminis	river	3rd n.



lacus, lacūs	lake	4th m.
ventus, ventūs	wind	2nd m.
nubes, nubis	cloud	3rd m.
vita, vitae	life	1st f. vita,
arbor, arboris	tree	3rd f. Arbor, arboreal
herba, herbae	grass, herb	1st f. Herb, herbal
sol, solis	sun	3rd m. solar
luna, lunae	moon	1st f. lunar
stella, stellae	star	1st f. Stellar, star, constellation
Caelum, caeli	Sky, heaven	2nd n. celestial
Oceanus, oceani	ocean	2nd m. ocean
Litus, litoris	Shore, coast	3rd n. lital
Insula, insulae	island	1st f. insular
Campus, campi	Plain, field	2nd m. campus
Collis, collis	hill	3rd m.
Arena, arenae	sand	1st f.
Saxum, saxi	Rock, boulder	2nd n.



Relative Clauses

A relative clause is a clause that describes a noun. In English, “who is talking” in “The man who talks is happy.” describes “the man”. In Latin, we use “qui” to usually start relative clauses, corresponding to “who/which/that.”

Returning to our previous example, “The man who talks is happy” in Latin is “vir qui inquit laeta est” (note that *qui* agrees with the masculine singular *vir*.) That being said, the relative pronoun must agree in both gender and number with its antecedent. However, the case and gender (and even number) of the relative pronoun is not always nominative in every situation, and could be used in times like “vir quem audio” (the man who I hear).

Indirect Statement

A direct statement would be a statement like “canem vidimus” (we saw the dog). If my friend (say that he’s a boy) says that we saw the dog, then we have an indirect statement.

An indirect statement is made from a main verb (saying, perceiving, or thinking) plus an accusative plus an infinitive. Thus, the translation of “He says that we saw the dog” becomes “dicit nos canem vidisse”, where “dicit” is the main verb, “nos” is the accusative, and “vidisse” is the infinitive (here, in the perfect tense.) The infinitive doesn’t change the main verb’s tense - only the action the infinitive says. (That is, changing “vidisse” to “videre” will not result in changing “says”, only “saw” to “see” again.)

The main verb is usually a verb of saying, thinking, or perceiving, like “puto” (I think), “cogito” (I think), “scio” (I know), “dico” (I say), “narro” (I tell), “video” (I see), and “sentio” (I feel).

And that's it.

Some Common Abbreviations

Abbreviation	Latin literal translation	English literal translation	Actual meaning
i.e.	id est	that is	that is
etc.	et cetera	and the rest	and the rest
et al.	et alia	and others	and others
ibid.	ibidem	in the same place	in the same place (as before)
vs.	versus	against	against
N.B.	nota bene	note well	note well
A.D.	anno Domini	in the year of our Lord	year after 0 (and the BC era)
A.M. / P.M.	ante meridiem / post meridiem	before noon / after noon	before 12:00 / after 12:00
ca.	circa	around	around this time
–	ad hoc	to this	unplanned
sc.	scilicet	namely	namely
P.S.	post scriptum	after the script	Something written in addition to a letter